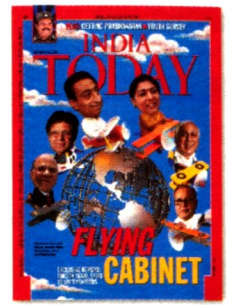




SAURABH SINGH



"Flying Cabinet",
February 18, 2008

"Do gift a copy of the magazine to all these politicians. Some of them may want to mend their ways after reading the article."

A.E. CHARLES, Coimbatore

On Toes and Trips

Even the entire year's salary of most of the middle class people is less than what the exchequer spends on a single foreign trip of these ministers ("Frequent Fliers", February 18). They seem to have been elected with a "golden" spoon in their mouths.

GEETHA V., on e-mail

That 71 of the 78 cabinet ministers have clocked several flying points is not as surprising as the fact that seven of them have not been abroad even once. They should be honoured in some way for not wasting valuable foreign exchange, and whatever cost that recognition involves should be paid for by these 71 ministers.

JAYENDRA SONI, Chennai

This investigation must make the UPA Government prune foreign trips of its ministers considering that

at least 40 per cent of these are just ego trips.
VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
Dehradun

The cover story was quite interesting. Comparative figures for the NDA regime would have made the article livelier. I hope the story achieves flying results.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

Can the flying ministers take out some time to solve the problems of their own countrymen? And can the country be enlightened about the ways in which their foreign exploits helped the poor people of India? Is it really impossible to work for a prosperous India without visiting any foreign locale?

A. SRIKANTALAH, Bangalore

Startling statistics and revealing analysis highlight how the UPA ministers keep their government 'on-the-

move' with their foreign jaunts unrelated to their portfolio. One wonders what kind of justice Kamal Nath—the most widely travelled minister—has done to his constituency or country by spending one-third of his ministerial days abroad.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

Modi's Mojo

The chief ministers' survey tells us the obvious—that India loves Narendra Modi ("Winners and Losers", February 18). He is a real leader—somebody who not only wins elections on his own against all odds, but is also a visionary who takes care of the human aspect of development too.

SURESH PATANI, Vadodara

It is obvious that Modi's love for his people has made him the No.1 chief minister of the country. His love has only been reciprocated by the people.
MARIYA RAJAM, Kanyakumari

Jungle of Raj

The pictures in the story were a chilling reminder of the days of the Partition ("In Search of a Lost Cause", February 18). Raj Thackeray and his MNS must be taught a lesson in social engineering and right behaviour. They are not fighting for the Maratha pride, but are afraid of others succeeding in Maharashtra.

S. LAKSHMI, on e-mail

I do not support Thackeray in his undesirable anti-north Indian activities. But it is a fact that states like Uttar Pradesh and Bihar absorb a major chunk of the taxpayers' money and still remain backward. If their condition does not improve, things may go from bad to worse.

V.S. GANESHAN, Bangalore

The ongoing battle on the streets of Mumbai between the hooligans of MNS and